

Postpartum - Fever - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1439 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Postpartum fever or suspected infection assessment using published urgent maternal warning signs and C-section wound-infection guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [TEMPERATURE] What is the temperature?
2. [DURATION] How many days/weeks since delivery?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Any wound redness, foul-smelling discharge, urinary symptoms, or breast tenderness?
4. [YES_NO] If the patient is under 18, can they speak privately now, and do they say they feel safe with the accompanying adult?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → COVID-19 - Diagnosed or Suspected

Are cough, breathing symptoms, or a positive COVID-19 test the primary concern?

A COVID-19 respiratory presentation belongs in the authored COVID-19 - Diagnosed or Suspected pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Along with fever or feeling feverish, is there confusion, trouble breathing or very fast breathing, fainting, cold or clammy skin, or rapidly worsening severe illness?

These are systemic urgent maternal warning signs compatible with severe infection or sepsis and require immediate emergency care.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the measured temperature 38 C or higher, or is there feverishness with foul-smelling vaginal discharge, worsening lower abdominal pain, urinary symptoms, breast redness or pain, or a wound that is red, painful, swollen, opening, or draining fluid, without the emergency features above?

CDC lists a temperature of 100.4 F (38 C) or higher as an urgent maternal warning sign; focal postpartum infection features also need prompt clinical assessment.

Advice

Emergency postpartum sepsis precautions

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not let the patient drive. Tell the call handler that the patient gave birth recently. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening confusion; worsening breathing.

Urgent postpartum fever review

- Arrange prompt clinical assessment through the locally approved Qatar maternity pathway; the exact non-emergency destination requires local approval.
- Call Back If: fever worsens; any new symptoms develop.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not let the patient drive. Tell the call handler that the patient gave birth recently. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Caesarean section - Recovery" (wound infection warning), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/caesarean-section/recovery/>
- CDC Hear Her urgent maternal warning signs (temperature 100.4 F / 38 C or higher; severe systemic symptoms), <https://www.cdc.gov/hearher/>

Provenance

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